

# Use Salt for Basic Configuration Management

Salt, the Python-based open source configuration management and remote execution application, can be used to actually do basic configuration management. Let's find out how.



This article assumes that you are familiar with what is in the following list (or have read Part 1 of this series on Salt in the December 2014 edition of *Open Source For You*).

- Installing SaltStack
- Setting up master and minion
- Establishing a relationship between master and minion

In this column, we will look at how to actually use Salt to do some basic configuration management.

## Basic Salt commands for documentation/help

Salt provides a wide range of system level documentation on how to use any of its modules.

```
salt '*' sys.doc (list all modules' documentation for all minions)
salt '*' sys.doc apache.fullversion (list module specific documentation for all minions)
```

It offers a minion availability test, as follows:

```
salt '*' test.ping (for all nodes)
```

```
salt 'machine-name' test.ping (for specific node)
```

\*\* is the target, which specifies all minions. You must specify the minion *id/hostname* if you want to target a specific minion.

To install a package, type:

```
salt '*' pkg.install dialog
```

For user addition, type:

```
salt '*' user.add osfy
```

To query disk usage, type:

```
salt 'myminion' disk.percent
```

```
myminion:
-----
/:
    31%
/boot:
```